Skills in Demand visa (subclass 482)

Specialist Skills stream

This visa enables employers to address labour shortages by bringing in skilled workers where they can't source an appropriately skilled Australian worker.

Personalise this page...

For Applicants For Sponsors

Step by step

Step 1

Before you apply

Things you will need to arrange before you apply could include obtaining a skills assessment, an English proficiency exam or undertaking a health assessment. You might also want to get help with your application.

Be nominated by your prospective employer

Ensure your prospective employer has or will nominate you for a nominated position in their business.

You will need the Transaction Reference Number (TRN) for the nomination application that your employer has lodged on your behalf when you submit your SID visa application online at step 3. You can request this information from your employer if you do not have this number.

Check your passport

You need a valid passport or other travel document for this visa. If you plan to get a new passport, you should do so before applying for your visa.

Get your skills assessed

Ask a question

For some occupations and classes of applicants, it is mandatory to obtain a skills assessment, or have organised to obtain one at the time you apply for your SID visa.

Check if you need to get a skills assessment *(https://immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/visas/working-in-australia/skills-assessment)* for your occupation.

If you are required to undertake a mandatory skills assessment we prefer that the assessment is completed before you apply for the visa. However, you can apply once you have the skills assessment reference number. You will need to record the skills assessment reference number in your SID visa application when submitting your online application. It cannot be submitted after you submit your application.

Organise English exams

If you need to show you meet the minimum standards of English language proficiency *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/skills-in-demand-visa-subclass-482/sufficient-english)*, organise to take your English language tests. English language test results can be no more than 3 years old.

Organise health exams

You will need to have health examinations. You can complete them before you apply or you can wait until we tell you to have them.

Find out the examinations you need *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health)* and how to arrange them before you apply.

Get help with your application

Only some people can help you with your application. If you appoint someone to give you immigration assistance they must be:

- a registered migration agent *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/using-a-migration-agent)*
- a legal practitioner *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/using-a-legal-practitioner)*, or
- an exempt person *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/exempt-person)*.

You can appoint anyone to receive documents *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/authorised-recipents)* on your behalf relating to your visa matter.

Step 2

Gather your documents

Documents you may have to provide could include documents for your identity, character, skills, work experience, health and English language proficiency.

Provide accurate information

Provide accurate information. See what happens if you can't prove your identity or don't provide true information *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/providing-accurate-information)*.

Identity documents

We need proof of your identity. If you can't prove your identity:

- we will refuse your visa application
- we might not grant you another visa for 10 years
- we might not grant any family members you listed on your application a visa for 10 years

Provide the pages of your current passport showing your photo, personal details, and passport issue and expiry dates.

Also provide proof of change of name, if this applies.

Documents that prove a change of name include:

- a marriage or divorce certificate
- change of name documents from an Australian Registry of Births, Deaths and Marriages, or the relevant overseas authority
- documents that show other names you have been known by
- deed poll certificate
- statutory declaration if the differences are small

Skills and occupation documents

If it is mandatory for you to provide a skills assessment or proof that you have arranged to obtain one

We won't process your application if you don't provide this.

- For SID skills assessment by Trades Recognition Australia *(https://www.tradesrecognitionaustralia.gov.au/)*, your application must include the relevant skills assessment reference number.
- For the occupations of Project and Program Administrator or Specialist Manager not elsewhere classified you must include the relevant skills assessment reference number for your VETASSESS Skills Assessment *(http://www.vetassess.com.au/Skills-Assessment-for-Migration/General-Occupations)*.

If you are claiming an exemption from undertaking a mandatory skills assessment because of an exemption specified in the legislative instrument you must provide relevant evidence with your application.

If it is not mandatory for you to undertake a skills assessment

You are still required to provide other evidence to demonstrate that you have relevant skills, qualifications and employment background to undertake the nominated occupation.

This may include, but is not limited to:

- a copy of relevant qualification certificates (professional and educational)
- a copy of any required registration/licensing
- previous employment reference
- your curriculum vitae or resumé
- previous employment references

Registration/licensing

Where relevant, you must provide evidence from the relevant Australian registration or licensing authority (in the state or territory in which you will be working) that you hold or will be able to meet necessary registration or licensing requirements. The information relating to registration or licensing required must specify the type of registration or licensing held and the name and contact details for the registering or licensing authority. Your approved sponsor should be able to provide you with the necessary licensing and registration information.

Registration for Medical Practitioners

You must provide written evidence that the relevant medical board has recognised your qualifications and that you have been registered or will be given medical registration.

Curriculum vitae (CV) / Resume

Curriculum vitae (CV) or resumé that you provide must include full employment and educational history, including dates and positions held, for at least the last 5 years.

Employment references
Employment references that you provide should cover a period sufficient to demonstrate relevant skill level. They must be on the letterhead of the employer and include:

- the name, title and contact details of the referee
- employment details your position
- dates of service

English language proficiency documents

Provide proof that you meet the minimum standards of English language proficiency *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/skills-in-demand-visa-subclass-482/sufficient-english)*, or that you are exempt from the requirement to show this.

Health insurance

You will need to provide evidence of adequate health insurance *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health/adequate-health-insurance)* for you and any secondary applicants for the duration of your stay in Australia.

Reciprocal healthcare agreements

Some countries have a reciprocal healthcare agreement with Australia. Find out more from Services Australia about reciprocal healthcare agreement *(https://www.privatehealth.gov.au/health_insurance/overseas/index.htm)*.

Character documents

Provide an Australian police certificate *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/character)* if you have spent a total of 12 months or more in Australia in the last 10 years since you turned 16.

We only accept complete disclosure National Police Certificates issued by the Australian Federal Police *()*. We do not accept standard disclosure certificates or national police certificates issued by Australian state or territory police.

For immigration purposes, Australian police certificates are valid for 12 months from the date of issue.

Also provide:

- an overseas police certificate from every country *(/help-support/contact-us/offices-and-locations/list)*, including your home country, where you spent a total of 12 months or more in the last 10 years since you turned 16
    - if required, penal check letters are available by contacting espd@homeaffairs.gov.au *(mailto:espd@homeaffairs.gov.au)* and include the words “Front end load – Penal Check Letter” in the subject line of your email.
- military service records or discharge papers if you served in the armed forces of any country

Further information is available at: Character requirements for visas *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/character)*

If you are sponsored by an accredited sponsor *(/visas/employing-and-sponsoring-someone/sponsoring-workers/becoming-a-sponsor/accredited-sponsor)*, you are not required to obtain police certificates from countries other than Australia **provided** you attach a reference from your accredited sponsor confirming you are of good character and you have not been convicted of any criminal offences.

We will tell you if you also need to complete and provide the following forms:

- Form 80 – Personal particulars for character assessment (596KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/80.pdf)*
- Form 1221 Additional personal particulars information (331KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/1221.pdf)*

Partner documents

Provide:

- identity documents
- character documents
- documents about other relationships, if applicable

Provide either:

- your current marriage certificate or
- enough documents to prove you are in a de facto relationship with your partner

Documents that prove your de facto relationship include:

- joint bank account statements
- billing accounts in joint names
- joint leases or mortgages
- documents that show you have lived at the same address as your partner

Dependants under 18 documents

For every dependant under 18 years old who is applying with you, provide:

- the pages of their current passport showing their photo, personal details, and passport issue and expiry dates (if your child is under 5 years old you can include them in the application without a passport)
- copies of birth certificates or the family book showing the names of both parents of all your dependent children
- copies of the adoption papers, if applicable
- character documents, if applicable.

Parental responsibility documents

You must get consent for the child to come to Australia from anyone who:

- has a legal right to decide where the child lives and
- is not coming to Australia with the child

They must complete either:

- Form 1229 Consent form to grant an Australian visa to a child under the age of 18 years (276KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/1229.pdf)*
- a statutory declaration giving their consent for the child to visit Australia on this visa

Include a document with the signature and photo of the person who completed the form or declaration, such as a:

- passport
- driver's licence

Dependants over 18 documents

For every dependant 18 years old or older who is applying with you, provide:

- identity documents
- documents about their other relationships, if applicable
- character documents

Proof of dependency

Where you need to prove that a person is dependent on you, provide:

- a completed Form 47a Details of a child or other dependent family member aged 18 years or over (307KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/47a.pdf)*
- proof of your relationship with the dependent such as a birth certificate or adoption papers

You must also prove this person has been financially dependent on you for at least 12 months before you apply. You could provide:

- proof they live with you
- their tax records
- proof they are currently studying

Tell us you are getting help

To nominate someone to:

- receive your correspondence, use Form 956A Appointment or withdrawal of an authorised recipient (301KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/956a.pdf)*
- provide immigration assistance, use Form 956 Appointment of a registered migration agent, legal practitioner or exempt person (308KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/956.pdf)*.

Upload your written notification or your forms to ImmiAccount *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/overview)*.

Prepare your documents

Translate

Have all non-English documents translated into English.

Provide original and translated documents in your application.

Translators in Australia must be accredited by the National Accreditation Authority for Translators and Interpreters *(https://www.naati.com.au/)*.

Translators outside Australia do not have to be accredited. But on each translation, they must include their:

- full name
- address and telephone number
- qualifications and experience in the language they are translating

These details must be in English.

Note: You do not need to have any documents certified.

Scan or photograph

Scan or photograph all documents (English and non-English) in colour.

The scans and photos must be clear.

If a document is more than one page, save it all as one file.

Attach

Attach a document only once, even if you are using it to show more than one thing.

Learn more about attaching documents *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online#content-index-2)*.

Step 3

Apply for the visa

You apply for this visa online.

Apply for the visa online in ImmiAccount

1. Log in or create an ImmiAccount *(https://online.immi.gov.au/ola/app)*
2. Attach documents *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online#content-index-2)*
3. Pay the application fee *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/online/how-to-pay)*. We will not process your application until you pay the fee.
4. Note the Transaction reference number

Each family member must have their application charge paid and documents attached to their application.

Step 4

After you apply

We will let you know when we have received your application and documents. See what you can and must do after you apply.

Status updates

We can't give updates on applications within the standard processing time.

We might ask for more information. We are not obligated to request further information or documents and can make a decision on the information provided.

Travel after you apply

Do not arrange to travel to Australia until we let you know, in writing, that we have granted you the visa.

Health exams

If you didn't have health examinations *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/health)* before you applied, we will let you know if you need them.

Biometrics

We might ask for biometrics *(/help-support/meeting-our-requirements/biometrics)* (fingerprints and photo). We will let you know if you need to provide them.

Attach more information

If you didn't send us all documents when you applied, attach them as soon as you can in ImmiAccount *(http://online.immi.gov.au/ola/app)*.

We might also ask you to provide more information.

We are not obligated to request additional information or documents and can make a decision on your visa application based on the information available at the time.

Stay lawful

If you are in Australia, make sure you stay lawful by holding a valid visa while we process your application. You must hold a substantive visa or a Bridging A *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/bridging-visa-a-010)*, Bridging B *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/bridging-visa-b-020)* or Bridging C *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/bridging-visa-c-030)* visa for your visa application to be processed.

If you were in Australia when you applied for this visa, you may have been granted a Bridging visa. If your current visa expires before we decide on your application, the Bridging visa will start. You can stay in Australia on the Bridging visa while we process your new visa application.

Do not ask us to cancel your current visa. If your visa is cancelled, you will:

- be staying in Australia unlawfully
- not be eligible for a Bridging visa.

Learn more about travelling on your visa *(/entering-and-leaving-australia/travelling-and-your-visa/travel-on-a-bridging-visa)*.

Learn about visa expiry *(/visas/visa-about-to-expire)*.

Add family

Refer to Include other family members *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/skills-in-demand-visa-subclass-482/specialist-skills-stream#About)* for details of family members who can be included in your visa application.

You can't add family members to your visa application **after** it has been submitted.

If you have submitted your visa application and we are processing it, certain family members that were not included in your visa application can submit a subsequent entrant *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/skills-in-demand-visa-subclass-482/subsequent-entrant)* application.

Alternatively, if we have granted you a visa, certain family members may apply to join you in Australia later as a subsequent entrant.

Newborn children

Find out what to do if you have a child after you applied for this visa *(/change-in-situation/had-a-baby)*.

Mistakes on your application

Let us know as soon as you can.

Complete Form 1023 Notification of incorrect answers (168KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/1023.pdf)*.

Help with your application

Let us know if you no longer want someone to:

- receive your correspondence - complete Form 956A Appointment or withdrawal of an authorised recipient (301KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/956a.pdf)*
- provide immigration advice - complete Form 956 Appointment of a registered migration agent, legal practitioner or exempt person (308KB PDF) *(/form-listing/forms/956.pdf)*.

Upload your written notification or your forms to ImmiAccount *(/help-support/applying-online-or-on-paper/overview)*.

For more information see Who can help you with your application *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/overview)*.

Tell us if things change

Things you need to let us know about after you have applied include:

- changes to your phone number, email, address or passport
- changes to your marital or de facto status
- the birth of a child
- you want to withdraw your application

See how to tell us if your situation changes *(/change-in-situation)*.

Step 5

Visa outcome

You can be in or outside Australia when we decide on your visa application.

We must have approved your employer's nomination before we can grant you a SID visa.

We will let you know our decision about your visa application in writing. We will tell you:

- your visa grant number
- the date your visa starts
- your visa conditions

Keep a copy of the decision with you when in Australia.

If we refuse your visa we will let you know in writing. We will tell you:

- why it was refused
- whether you have a right to a review of the decision

We will not refund the application fee if we refuse your application.

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